RELATIONSHIP CHECK-IN · PAPER VERSION

How is it going, from both sides?

Each of you answers 32 short statements on your own, then guesses how the other sees things. It takes about ten minutes. Then you score it together and see how each of you sees the relationship, where you see it differently, how well you read each other, and what to work on first.

How to use it

1. **Each take your own copy** (Partner 1 and Partner 2, three pages each). Answer separately, without discussing or looking at each other's answers.
2. **Score together** using the scoring sheet, then compare your guesses on the "How well you read each other" page. About fifteen minutes with a pen.
3. **Pick one area to start with**, using the "Start here" page. Talk about the statements you answered most differently, and the blind spots, before trying to fix anything.
4. **Repeat it every month or so** with fresh copies, and write your scores on the tracking page to see what's changing.

Before you start

This check-in assumes you both feel safe to speak openly. If you feel afraid of your partner, or controlled by them (money, phone, who you see, where you go), don't do it together. Talk to someone on your own first. It's free and confidential.

1800RESPECT (family and domestic violence, 24/7): **1800 737 732** · **Lifeline** (crisis support, 24/7): **13 11 14** · In immediate danger: **000**

What it covers

Knowing each other · Curiosity about each other's inner world

Being there · Responding when the other reaches out

Repair · Getting back on track after a rupture

Intimacy · Physical closeness and sex

Appreciation · Feeling valued and liked

Handling conflict · How disagreements start and run

Trust and commitment · Feeling secure in each other

Teamwork · Sharing the load and the direction

This is a conversation starter, not a clinical assessment or a substitute for counselling. Scores and cut-offs are provisional and not clinically validated. There is also an app version where you each answer on your own phone and the scoring is done for you.

Partner 1: your answers

Name _____ **Date** _____

Answer on your own, without looking at your partner's copy. Circle one number for each statement, thinking about the past month. Go with your first reaction. Tick **n/a** only if an intimacy statement really doesn't fit your relationship.

1 Strongly disagree **2** Disagree **3** Mixed **4** Agree **5** Strongly agree

Knowing each other

1	I know what's currently worrying or stressing my partner.	1	2	3	4	5
2	My partner knows my hopes and goals for the next few years.	1	2	3	4	5
3	We still talk about things other than logistics, kids or chores.	1	2	3	4	5
4	Lately it feels like we're living parallel lives.	1	2	3	4	5

Appreciation

5	I regularly feel appreciated by my partner.	1	2	3	4	5
6	I often tell my partner what I admire or value about them.	1	2	3	4	5
7	My partner shows affection in ways that land for me.	1	2	3	4	5
8	I feel taken for granted.	1	2	3	4	5

Being there

9	When I reach out for attention or connection, my partner usually responds.	1	2	3	4	5
10	My partner is there for me when I'm having a hard time.	1	2	3	4	5
11	We make time for each other, even in busy weeks.	1	2	3	4	5
12	I often feel ignored or brushed off by my partner.	1	2	3	4	5

Handling conflict

13	We can raise a problem without it turning into an attack.	1	2	3	4	5
14	I feel heard when we disagree, even if we don't end up agreeing.	1	2	3	4	5
15	When we argue, one of us often shows contempt, such as sarcasm or mocking.	1	2	3	4	5
16	One of us often shuts down or walks away mid-disagreement.	1	2	3	4	5

Repair

17	After an argument we find our way back to each other fairly quickly.	1	2	3	4	5	
18	When one of us tries to calm things down mid-argument, the other accepts it.	1	2	3	4	5	
19	We can apologise to each other and mean it.	1	2	3	4	5	
20	Old hurts keep resurfacing because they never got resolved.	1	2	3	4	5	

Trust and commitment

21	I trust my partner to act in my best interests.	1	2	3	4	5	
22	I feel secure in our commitment to each other.	1	2	3	4	5	
23	My partner is honest with me, including about difficult things.	1	2	3	4	5	
24	I sometimes wonder whether I'd be better off out of this relationship.	1	2	3	4	5	

Intimacy

25	I'm satisfied with the physical affection between us.	1	2	3	4	5	n/a
26	I'm satisfied with our sex life.	1	2	3	4	5	n/a
27	We can talk openly about what each of us wants in intimacy.	1	2	3	4	5	n/a
28	Physical closeness has become rare between us.	1	2	3	4	5	n/a

Teamwork

29	The work of running our life together feels fairly shared, including the planning and remembering.	1	2	3	4	5	
30	We make big decisions (money, family, where we live) together.	1	2	3	4	5	
31	We have a shared picture of where our life is heading.	1	2	3	4	5	
32	Outside pressures, such as work, money or family, regularly spill into how we treat each other.	1	2	3	4	5	

How do you think your partner sees it?

For each area, circle how you think your partner would rate it over the past month. You'll compare these guesses with their own answers.

Area	Really struggling	Not great	Mixed	Good	Really good
Knowing each other Curiosity about each other's inner world	○	○	○	○	○
Appreciation Feeling valued and liked	○	○	○	○	○
Being there Responding when the other reaches out	○	○	○	○	○
Handling conflict How disagreements start and run	○	○	○	○	○
Repair Getting back on track after a rupture	○	○	○	○	○
Trust and commitment Feeling secure in each other	○	○	○	○	○
Intimacy Physical closeness and sex	○	○	○	○	○
Teamwork Sharing the load and the direction	○	○	○	○	○

What matters most to you right now?

Tick the two areas you most want to be good at the moment.

- ☐ **Knowing each other** — Curiosity about each other's inner world
- ☐ **Appreciation** — Feeling valued and liked
- ☐ **Being there** — Responding when the other reaches out
- ☐ **Handling conflict** — How disagreements start and run
- ☐ **Repair** — Getting back on track after a rupture
- ☐ **Trust and commitment** — Feeling secure in each other
- ☐ **Intimacy** — Physical closeness and sex
- ☐ **Teamwork** — Sharing the load and the direction

Partner 2: your answers

Name _____ **Date** _____

Answer on your own, without looking at your partner's copy. Circle one number for each statement, thinking about the past month. Go with your first reaction. Tick **n/a** only if an intimacy statement really doesn't fit your relationship.

1 Strongly disagree **2** Disagree **3** Mixed **4** Agree **5** Strongly agree

Knowing each other

1	I know what's currently worrying or stressing my partner.	1	2	3	4	5
2	My partner knows my hopes and goals for the next few years.	1	2	3	4	5
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28	Physical closeness has become rare between us.	1	2	3	4	5	n/a

Teamwork

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Appreciation Feeling valued and liked	○	○	○	○	○
Being there Responding when the other reaches out	○	○	○	○	○
Handling conflict How disagreements start and run	○	○	○	○	○
Repair Getting back on track after a rupture	○	○	○	○	○
Trust and commitment Feeling secure in each other	○	○	○	○	○
Intimacy Physical closeness and sex	○	○	○	○	○
Teamwork Sharing the load and the direction	○	○	○	○	○

What matters most to you right now?

Tick the two areas you most want to be good at the moment.

- ☐ **Knowing each other** — Curiosity about each other's inner world
- ☐ **Appreciation** — Feeling valued and liked
- ☐ **Being there** — Responding when the other reaches out
- ☐ **Handling conflict** — How disagreements start and run
- ☐ **Repair** — Getting back on track after a rupture
- ☐ **Trust and commitment** — Feeling secure in each other
- ☐ **Intimacy** — Physical closeness and sex
- ☐ **Teamwork** — Sharing the load and the direction

Score it together

1. For each area, add up each partner's four circled numbers. For the statements in the **Reverse** column, count **6 minus** the number circled (so 5 counts as 1, 4 as 2, 3 stays 3). These are warning-sign statements, where agreeing is a bad sign. If you ticked **n/a** for some intimacy statements, add up the ones you answered, divide by how many that was and multiply by 4 (round to the nearest whole number). If all four are n/a, leave intimacy out of your overall score.
2. Each total is between 4 and 20. Convert it to a score out of 100 using the table below.
3. Write the gap between your two scores, and the status: go through the four rules below in order and use the first one that fits. Circle the names of the areas either of you ticked as mattering most.

Area	Statements	Reverse	P1 total	P1 score	P2 total	P2 score	Gap	Status
Knowing each other	1–4	4						
Appreciation	5–8	8						
Being there	9–12	12						
Handling conflict	13–16	15, 16						
Repair	17–20	20						
Trust and commitment	21–24	24						
Intimacy	25–28	28						
Teamwork	29–32	32						
Overall (average of the 8 scores)								

Total to score

Total	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
Score	0	6	13	19	25	31	38	44	50	56	63	69	75	81	88	94	100

Needs work
Either of you scored below 55 (a total of 12 or less).

Seen differently
Both 55+, but your scores are 20 or more points apart.

Strength
You both scored 75+ (a total of 16 or more).

Steady
Anything else.

Statements to talk about

Go through both copies statement by statement. Note any where your answers are two or more apart (after reversing the warning-sign statements). These are the best conversation starters.

Write the statement numbers in the boxes.

How well you read each other

Turn each guess into a number, then compare it with the other person's own score from the scoring sheet. A guess 25 or more points away is a **blind spot**: one of the most useful things to talk about. Ask what the other person sees that you didn't.

0 Really struggling **25** Not great **50** Mixed **75** Good **100** Really good

Area	P1's guess	P2's score	Points off	P2's guess	P1's score	Points off
Knowing each other						
Appreciation						
Being there						
Handling conflict						
Repair						
Trust and commitment						
Intimacy						
Teamwork						
Average points off						

When a guess was higher than the other person's score, the guesser thought their partner was happier with that area than they are. When it was lower, they thought their partner was less happy than they are.

Start here

Pick up to three areas marked **Needs work** or **Seen differently**, starting with the lowest score, and put ones either of you said matter most ahead of the rest. Try the matching suggestion for a week, then check in again. For a **Seen differently** area, start by understanding why your views differ before trying to fix anything.

Knowing each other

For a week, each ask one open question a day that isn't about logistics: “What's on your mind about work at the moment?”, “What are you looking forward to?”

Appreciation

Each evening this week, name one specific thing your partner did that you valued. Specific beats general: “Thanks for handling the school call” lands better than “thanks for everything”.

Being there

Agree a 10-minute daily check-in with phones away. Notice small bids for attention (a comment, a sigh, a shared link) and respond to them.

Handling conflict

Raise issues as “I feel … about … and I need …” rather than “You always …”. Pick one recurring disagreement and each explain the other's side until they agree you've got it right.

Repair

Agree a phrase either of you can use to pause an argument, and a rule that you come back to it after at least 20 minutes, once you've both calmed down.

Trust and commitment

Talk about what would help each of you feel more secure. If trust has been broken (an affair, hidden money, lies), this is the area where a couples counsellor helps most.

Intimacy

Each privately write three things that help you feel close, physical or not, then swap lists. Talk about one item from each list, without negotiating yet.

Teamwork

Together, list every recurring task (including the remembering and planning) and who owns it. Rebalance the two that feel most unfair.

If several areas need work, or the same argument keeps coming back, a couples counsellor is a good next step.

Track your check-ins

Copy each area's scores from the scoring sheet after every check-in, ideally about a month apart. Look for moves of 13 points or more. One answer moving one step shifts an area by about 6 points, so smaller changes are mostly noise.

Area	Check-in 1		Check-in 2		Check-in 3		Check-in 4		Check-in 5		Check-in 6	
	P1	P2	P1	P2	P1	P2	P1	P2	P1	P2	P1	P2
Date												
Knowing each other												
Appreciation												
Being there												
Handling conflict												
Repair												
Trust and commitment												
Intimacy												
Teamwork												
Overall												

What we agreed to try

Date

Date

Date

Date

Date

Date